

GROUP	DURATION	BASE	LODGING	TRANSPORT	PILOT PRICE
6 guests	5 days / 4 nights	Blera (VT)	Antonella's B&B	Self-drive van	€850/person

PILOT OBJECTIVES

- 1 Confirm which activities actually work with a real group
- 2 Build trust and lock in rates with local partners (Renzo, Emiliano, grove owner, Pino)
- 3 Identify what to cut, improve, or reorder in the schedule
- 4 Get photos, video, and written guest feedback for the website
- 5 Test the van logistics end-to-end (FCO pickup, daily driving, ZTL, timing)

PRE-DEPARTURE CHECKLIST — CONFIRM BEFORE ANYONE BOOKS A FLIGHT

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|---|--|
| ☐ Grove owner confirmed, dates locked, harvest window verified no more than 2 weeks before | ☐ Activity insurance — policy read, hands-on work (harvest, leather) explicitly covered |
| ☐ Frantoio pressing appointment reserved (books up in October) | ☐ Cristina available for Day 4 dinner — menu and logistics agreed |
| ☐ Renzo available — date and project scope agreed (keyring or card wallet, not full belt) | ☐ Toto available for Day 3 gnocchi session |
| ☐ Emiliano confirmed OR backup slot pre-arranged (horse riding / Norchia hike with Pino) | ☐ Paolo's number saved — taxi backup for individual transfers to FCO (€50/trip) |
| ☐ Antonella's B&B — 3 rooms reserved, deposit paid, ZTL/parking clarified with Pino | ☐ Dietary restrictions collected in writing from every guest |
| ☐ 9-seater van booked at FCO (Europcar/Hertz/Sixt) — confirmed it fits 6 adults + bags | ☐ Cancellation policy sent and acknowledged by all guests |
| | ☐ €850/person deposits received before booking anything non-refundable |
| | ☐ Next group date decided — set before the pilot departs, not after |

DAY-BY-DAY SCHEDULE

DAY 1 Arrival & First Impressions

13:00	Pick up van at FCO — meet guests at Arrivals	Fiumicino FCO	—
13:30	Drive north to Blera (~1h 20m) along the Aurelia	Minivan	fuel incl.
15:00	Check in	Antonella's B&B	—
15:30	Welcome walk — Piazza Roma, church, ravine viewpoint over the Biedano valley	Blera centro	free
16:30	First espresso and aperitivo in the square	Bar Etruria	€40
19:30	Welcome dinner — bruschetta, affettati, pasta al pomodoro, porchetta, dolce, local wine	Beccone / La Torretta	€210

Flight delayed / guests arrive late: Skip the walk. Go straight to Bar Etruria at 17:30 and push dinner to 20:00. The walk can slot in before Day 2's grove if needed.

DAY 2 Olive Harvest & Panonto

07:30	Self-catered breakfast — cornetti from the bar, yogurt, fruit	<i>B&B / Bar Etruria</i>	€35
08:00	Drive to olive grove (~5 min)	<i>Blera territory</i>	—
08:15	Olive harvest — nets, hand-raking, sorting. Midway break: bread, oil, water	<i>Olive grove</i>	€150
12:30	Drive to frantoio	<i>Minivan</i>	—
12:45	Oil pressing — washing, crushing, centrifuge. Taste the fresh oil. Each guest takes home 1 bottle (250ml) of oil from today's press	<i>Frantoio locale</i>	€130
13:30	Panonto — back at the grove. Light the embers. Bread grilled on the fire, rubbed with garlic, drenched in the oil just pressed. Salsicce, grilled vegetables, local wine. Guests cook alongside	<i>Grove / campo</i>	€80
15:30	Return to B&B. Free afternoon.	<i>Antonella's B&B</i>	—
17:00	Optional walk to the Etruscan necropolis (15 min on foot)	<i>Blera necropolis</i>	free
19:30	Dinner — acquacotta, tagliatelle al ragù, bistecca, roast potatoes, torta della nonna, house wine	<i>Beccone Albergo</i>	€180

Rain on Day 2: Light rain — harvest goes ahead, it's messy and memorable. Heavy rain: swap harvest to Day 3 morning, move Renzo to Day 2 afternoon (indoors). Panonto in heavy rain doesn't work — covered lunch at Beccone instead (add ~€60). Agree the rain plan with the grove owner before the trip.

Olives not ready: Highest-probability risk. Confirm with grove owner 2 weeks AND 3 days before. Backup: San Giovenale hike with Pino (free, half day) + frantoio visit to taste last year's oil + standalone panonto in the evening.

Guest opts out of physical work: Don't push. Give them the photographer role. Most join once they see the others — don't make it awkward if they don't.

08:00	Self-catered breakfast	B&B	€35
09:30	Walk to Renzo's workshop	Blera centro	—
09:45	Leather workshop with Renzo (3h) — each guest makes one object (card wallet or keyring), keeps it. Renzo guides through cutting, hole-punching, waxed linen stitching, edge finishing	Renzo's bottega	€300
12:45	Coffee in the square	Bar Etruria	€20
13:15	Lunch at Emiliano's — full affettati board: lonza, guanciale, coppa, salsiccia stagionata. Homemade bread, local cheeses. Emiliano explains the curing process over the table	Emiliano's	€180
15:30	Free time at B&B	Antonella's B&B	—
18:00	Gnocchi with Toto — guests make traditional Lazio gnocchi from scratch in the kitchen alongside Toto, a local friend. Make the dough, roll, cut, sauce	Host kitchen	€40
20:00	Dinner on the terrace — eat the gnocchi just made. Host cooks the rest: secondo, vegetables, wine. Informal, private, the best evening of the trip	Private terrace	€60

This is the evening guests will tell people about — gnocchi they made themselves, eaten on a terrace in a village they'd never heard of. It costs €100 total and no restaurant can replicate it.

Emiliano cancels (or was never confirmed): Activate backup 3 weeks before — not on the day. Option A: horseback riding at Maneggio Civitella Cesi (~€240–300). Option B: Norchia hike with Pino (free, half day, dramatic). Lunch becomes a simple self-catered spread (€30). Pre-book the backup and cancel it if Emiliano confirms.

Renzo runs long: Most likely overrun of the trip. Build in a 45-min buffer — push Emiliano's lunch to 14:00 if needed. The gnocchi evening at 18:00 is flexible by 30–45 min.

Toto unavailable: You run the gnocchi session yourself. Or swap to a dish you know well — cacio e pepe, pasta al pomodoro. The activity is cooking together, not the specific recipe.

DAY 4 Tarquinia, Coast & Cristina's

08:00	Early self-catered breakfast	B&B	€35
08:15	Drive to Tarquinia (~50 min)	Minivan	fuel incl.
09:15	Necropoli di Tarquinia (UNESCO) — Etruscan painted tombs. 2,500-year-old frescoes: banquets, dolphins, dancers. Host-guided. Cool inside, no crowds in October	Tarquinia necropolis	€72
11:00	Museo Nazionale Tarquiniense — terracotta winged horses, Etruscan artefacts	Tarquinia centro	€36
12:00	Drive to the coast (~15 min)	Minivan	—
12:30	Seafood lunch — frittura di pesce, spaghetti alle vongole, white wine. October coast: quiet, locals only	Sant'Agostino restaurant	€180
14:30	Beach — walk, sit, decompress after the tombs	Sant'Agostino	free
16:00	Drive back to Blera (~55 min)	Minivan	fuel incl.
17:30	Free time	Antonella's B&B	—
19:30	Dinner at Cristina's — home restaurant. Private table, home cooking, back in Blera after a long day out. The most personal dinner of the trip	Casa di Cristina	€150

Rain on Day 4: Tarquinia is fully undercover — tombs and museum both work in any weather. Skip the beach, drive back after lunch. Optional afternoon stop: Palazzo dei Papi in Viterbo (interior, €4/person) on the way home.

Coast restaurant closed in October: Confirm before the trip. Fallback: eat in Tarquinia town — ask your contact for a reliable name.

Alternative day (if Tarquinia feels too far): Bulicame (free Dante thermal spring, 20 min) + Viterbo San Pellegrino quarter on foot + Lago di Vico in the afternoon. Dinner at Cristina's unchanged.

DAY 5 Slow Morning & Departure

08:00	Long breakfast — no agenda	B&B / Bar Etruria	€35
09:15	Final walk. Local shopping: honey, oil, wine, dried legumes	Blera centro	—
10:15	Farewells. Group photo in the piazza.	Piazza Roma	—
10:45	Drive to Fiumicino (~1h 30m)	Minivan	fuel incl.
12:15	Drop at Departures. Return van to rental desk.	FCO	—

Guest with early flight (before 14:00): Paolo (local taxi, €50 Blera → FCO) takes them separately. Ask all guests for flight times at booking — not on Day 4. Keep Paolo's number in your phone from Day 1.

TRANSPORT — SELF-DRIVE VAN

ITEM	COST
Van rental — 9-seater, 5 days, FCO pickup & return (Europcar / Hertz / Sixt)	€500
Diesel — ~310 km total, 34L @ €1.75/L + buffer	€80
Motorway tolls (FCO ↔ Blera × 2)	€16
Parking (Viterbo / Tarquinia + Blera ZTL area)	€15
Transport total	€611

Hiring a driver for 5 days costs ~€1,400. Self-drive saves €789. Book the van at least 3 weeks ahead — October is busy. Confirm ZTL parking with Pino or Antonella before arrival so you don't get fined by camera.

FULL COST SUMMARY — GROUP OF 6

CATEGORY	GROUP TOTAL	PER PERSON
Transport (van + fuel + tolls)	€611	€102

Lodging — Antonella's B&B (3 rooms × 4 nights @ €65/room)	€780	€130
Meals (all meals, 5 days)	€1,110	€185
Activities (grove, frantoio, oil, Renzo, Emiliano, Tarquinia entry)	€778	€130
Staff (Maria Grazia flat fee + Pino + Toto)	€400	€67
Activity insurance	€240	€40
Miscellaneous / buffer (5%)	€146	€24
Total cost	€4,065	€678

PILOT PRICE / PERSON	TOTAL REVENUE	BUFFER / PROFIT
€850	€5,100	€1,035

PRICING OPTIONS

OPTION	PRICE/ PERSON	REVENUE	RESULT	USE WHEN
At cost	€700	€4,200	Breakeven	Pure test, close friends only
Friends rate ✓ recommended	€850	€5,100	+€1,035	Trusted contacts, small buffer for what goes wrong
Soft launch	€1,000	€6,000	+€1,935	First paying guests outside your circle

Cancellation policy (send before guests confirm): Full refund if cancelled 30+ days before. 50% refund 15–30 days before. No refund inside 14 days — costs are already committed.

GROUP DYNAMICS — WHAT TO WATCH FOR

One person dominates with locals	Rotate who asks questions. Brief the group before Renzo and Emiliano: "let him explain first, then ask."
Tension between two guests	Don't take sides. Free time every afternoon is built in — let people decompress independently.
Someone disengages from an activity	Acknowledge it privately. Give them something useful: photos, carrying things, talking to the host. Don't make it a group moment.
The group goes quiet in a good way	Stop. Don't narrate it or move on. Let it breathe. These are the moments that become testimonials.
Minor injury (blister, cut at Renzo's, twisted ankle)	First aid kit in the van. Farmacia in Blera. Hospital: Ospedale di Viterbo, ~25 min drive.

WHAT TO DOCUMENT DURING THE PILOT

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|---|--|
| ☐ Photo of every activity: harvest, panonto fire, press, Renzo's hands, affettati board, gnocchi, terrace dinner | ☐ Note every moment where the group went quiet in a good way |
| ☐ Short video: oil coming out of the press, the embers being lit, Renzo stitching leather | ☐ Guest feedback form within 48h of return (5 questions: highlight? what to cut? would you recommend? what would you pay? one word for the trip?) |
| ☐ Note exact timings — when each session started and ended vs planned | ☐ Confirm with each partner: do they want to continue, and at what rate? |
| ☐ Note any moment where energy dropped or someone disengaged | ☐ Identify which activities were genuinely participatory vs which ones guests just watched |

AFTER THE PILOT — BEFORE LIFE GETS IN THE WAY

Debrief with Maria Grazia and Cristina	Within 1 week
Send thank-you + feedback form to all guests	Within 48 hours of return
	Within 2 weeks

Revise the itinerary based on what actually happened

Lock the date for the next group

Already decided before the pilot

Start building the website / landing page

Within 1 month

The most common failure mode isn't a bad experience — it's losing momentum after the pilot. Set the next group date before anyone gets on the plane home.